UNDERWOOD *One Page Summary for Smart Non-Experts*

The Definitive Second Breakthrough in Closed-Form Approximator Models for the Ellipse Perimeter

Monir Mamoun, independent researcher, 27 April 2026 (rev4) • introducing the **logatom** analytical framework • high-school algebra and calculus suffice to verify everything below

8 stored constants → 0.015 ppm (1 part in 67 million) • **13 constants → 3.3 parts per trillion** • **14 constants** → 2.1×10^{-13} **relative error** (machine precision) • **147,000**× better than AAA at the L-corner singularity • 2× better than the author's prior SRIRACHA on half the parameter budget

The 8-term "handy" formula (Formula 2 in the paper). For an ellipse with semi-axes $a \geq b > 0$, define

$$\xi \;=\; 1 - \left(\tfrac{a-b}{a+b}\right)^2, \qquad u \;=\; 2\xi - 1, \qquad \ln(1/\xi).$$

(Three numbers from a and b. No higher math.)
Then the perimeter is

$$\begin{aligned} P \;=\; \tfrac{a+b}{2} \cdot \Big[& + 7.042\,111\,928\,654\,361 \\ & - 0.890\,889\,229\,192\,585 \cdot u \\ & + 0.095\,701\,829\,579\,546 \cdot u^2 \\ & + 0.032\,481\,929\,448\,356 \cdot u^3 \\ & + 0.003\,778\,791\,638\,861 \cdot u^4 \\ & + 0.245\,916\,748\,527\,414 \cdot \xi^2 \cdot \ln(1/\xi) \\ & + 0.132\,325\,522\,582\,612 \cdot \xi^3 \cdot \ln(1/\xi) \\ & + 0.018\,709\,674\,870\,767 \cdot \xi^4 \cdot \ln(1/\xi) \Big]. \end{aligned}$$

Vocabulary used: addition, multiplication, the powers u^2, u^3, u^4, the natural logarithm ln. No elliptic integrals, no special functions, no series, no conditional branching, no iteration.

Why two "flavours" of terms? The first five lines (the u part) handle the *smooth* part of the perimeter. The last three lines (the $\xi^{2+j}\ln(1/\xi)$ part) handle the single sharp *crease* that appears at the degenerate limit $b \to 0$ (the ellipse collapsed to a line segment). Every previous compact formula tried to flatten that crease with smooth tools. UNDERWOOD names it explicitly with three log terms; the residual is then smooth, and a short polynomial in u handles it.

The mathematical advance behind the numbers. The named primitive $\xi^\alpha\,(\ln 1/\xi)^j$ is what the paper calls a *logatom*. It is the minimal building block for log-branch approximation, developed in *standard real analysis* — Chebyshev expansions, Bernstein's classical geometric-rate-on-analytic theorem, Heisenberg-ladder identities on Laguerre frames, Gamma-moment closed forms. Nothing exotic; you could have done all of it in 1950 if you had thought to. A second new result — the *Walsh–Bernstein separation theorem* — proves that *no* rational formula (numerator/denominator of polynomials) can ever match this approximator as the parameter budget grows.

Worked example: $a = 5$, $b = 3$ **(an ordinary ellipse).**
Step 1. Compute ξ. $\frac{a-b}{a+b} = \frac{2}{8} = 0.25$; $\xi = 1 - 0.25^2 = \mathbf{0.9375}$.
Step 2. Compute $u = 2\xi - 1 = \mathbf{0.875}$.
Step 3. Compute $\ln(1/\xi) = \ln(16/15) \approx \mathbf{0.064\,538\,521\,4}$.
Step 4. Add up the 8 terms.

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+7.042111928654          (constant)          +7.042111928654
-0.890889229193 × 0.875                      -0.779528075544
+0.095701829580 × 0.875^2 = 0.765625         +0.073275088876
+0.032481929448 × 0.875^3 = 0.669921875      +0.021759920580
+0.003778791639 × 0.875^4 = 0.586181641      +0.002215077716
+0.245916748527 × 0.9375^2 × 0.064538521        +0.013957604
+0.132325522583 × 0.9375^3 × 0.064538521        +0.007033876
+0.018709674871 × 0.9375^4 × 0.064538521        +0.000934339
sum                                          +6.381759759
```

Step 5. Multiply by $(a+b)/2 = 4$: $P \approx 4 \times 6.381\,759\,759 = \mathbf{25.527\,039\,04}$.

The exact perimeter (computed at 50-digit precision via the classical elliptic integral) is $P_{\text{exact}} = 25.526\,998\,863\,398\ldots$
Truncating the coefficients to 12 decimals (as printed above) loses about 4×10^{-5}. Using the full 40-decimal coefficients in the paper gives error $\approx 3 \times 10^{-9}$, comfortably inside the 0.015 ppm specification. Sub-ppm error from a hand-evaluable 8-term formula.

Side research direction: an EML translation. The author's logatom framework was developed independently in standard analysis; **none of UNDERWOOD's main results require EML to state, prove, or use.** However, after the framework was in place, the author observed that the logatoms $\xi^\alpha(\ln 1/\xi)^j$ are also expressible as finite trees in **Odrzywołek's EML grammar** (arXiv:2603.21852, 2026), where the single binary operation $\mathrm{eml}(x,y) = \exp(x) - \log(y)$ together with the constant 1 is a *Sheffer stroke* for the elementary functions. This is a parallel encoding of the same primitives in an alternative language; whether it yields additional insights for log-branch approximation is an *open research inquiry*, treated in the paper as supplementary research notes rather than as load-bearing theory. Readers using or proving things about UNDERWOOD do not need to learn EML.

Where to find more.

136-page paper	`two_foci_one_cup_ellipse_perimeter_mamoun_rev4.p`
Repository	github.com/monir/math
Reproduce all numbers	`python verify_all_claims_v2.py` (under 5 s)
Lean substrate slice	5 modules / 37 named declarations / sorry-free & axiom-free against Mathlib v4.28.0

`github.com/monir/math`